Recruitment, Selection & Training

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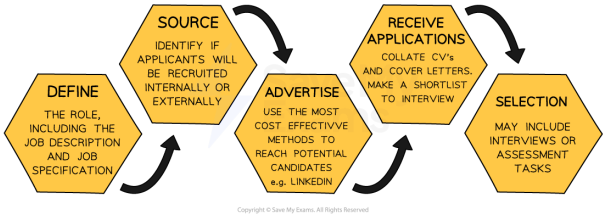
The recruitment and selection process

- **Recruitment** is the process of attracting and identifying potential job candidates who are suitable for a particular role
  - Recruitment activities include **job advertising, job fairs, social media outreach and referrals** from current employees
  - The goal of recruitment is to **create a pool of qualified candidates** who can be considered for the role
- **Selection** is the process of choosing the best candidate
  - Selection activities often involve **reviewing curricula vitae (CVs)** and **conducting interviews** or assessment tasks
  - The goal of selection is to hire the **most suitable candidate** for the job

The recruitment and selection process



The recruitment and selection process involves defining, sourcing, advertising roles and selecting a suitable candidate

1. Define the role

- Businesses should determine exactly what is required, and part of that is developing a job description and a person/job specification
  - **A job specification** outlines the qualifications, skills, experience and personal qualities required **from a candidate** for a specific job; e.g. problem solver, good communicator, able to code in Java

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

2. Determine the best source of candidates

- The business can advertise the role internally, externally, or a combination of both
  - **Internal recruitment i**s the process of hiring employees from within the organisation
    - It can involve the **promotion** or **redeployment** of staff to fill a vacant post
    - Vacancies are advertised internally on **staff notice boards**, in **newsletters** or via **in-house electronic communications**

Evaluation of internal recruitment

Advantages	Disadvantages

• Internal candidates are **already familiar with business culture and processes**
  ○ Can adapt to the role quickly
  ○ Little need for induction training
	• Can lead to **conflict** or **resentment**
	  ○ May affect **motivation** and **working relationships** betweer successful/rejected internal candidates

• The business has a good **understanding of the candidate's strengths, weaknesses, skills and aptitudes**
  ○ **Less risky** than employing an external candidate whose abilities are less well known
	• A **further vacancy is created** when an employee is promoted/redeployed
	  ○ External recruitment may be necessary to fill vacated job roles

• **Opportunities to progress** can be **motivating** for existing employees ○ Improves **loyalty and commitment**	• A **limited number of suitable applicants** may be available internally
• **Cheaper** and **quicker** to promote or redeploy existing staff rather than recruit externally	• Missed opportunity to inject **new ideas, experience** or **skills** into the business

- **External recruitment** is the process of hiring employees from outside the organisation
  - External recruitment can bring fresh ideas, experiences and perspectives to the organisation
  - It **overcomes some of the disadvantages of internal recruitment**
  - However, it is often **more expensive** than internal recruitment

Comparison of external recruitment methods

Method	Explanation
Referrals / personal recommendations	• Current employees may recommend a suitable candidate for a vacancy • Employees may be **rewarded** if a candidate is successfully appointed
Online advertising	• Vacancies can be advertised on a business's **own website** or on a **specialist recruitment website**, such as Glassdoor or CharityJobs.com • This method is relatively low-cost with a wide reach
Newspaper advertising	• Adverts to **attract local candidates** can be placed in district or regional newspapers • **High-profile vacancies**, such as public sector roles, may be advertised in national newspapers • Although relatively **expensive**, these ads can be **highly targeted**
Specialist trade publications	• Roles are advertised in magazines or newsletters that are read by **professionals in a particular industry** • Examples include fashion industry journal *Drapers* and education journal *The Times Educational Supplement* (*TES*)
Employment agencies	• Specialist recruitment agents **advertise roles on behalf of the business** • Some also conduct interviews or other selection activities • A recruitment **fee is charged** when the business appoints a candidate
Headhunting	• A headhunting agency makes attractive **approaches to highly qualified specialists** in a particular industry / with desired skills, experience or knowledge • A **significant fee** is payable once a candidate is appointed

Help me understand

	centres and, increasingly, online
Career fairs	• Events often hosted by **universities or industry bodies** to promote available opportunities • Attract significant numbers of **highly qualified, interested candidates**

3. Advertise

- Businesses with a strong social media presence can use these platforms to advertise cost-effectively, e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn, TikTok
- Depending on the nature of the business, there may be **specialist recruitment portals** through which they can advertise; these tend to **cost more**, e.g. The *TES* is one of the main publications used to recruit teaching staff

4. Receive applications

- The application stage involves **collecting information** from potential candidates
- A business may have its own application form, which should gather information such as personal details, qualifications and work experience
- Applicants may also be asked to submit their **CV** and a cover letter explaining why they believe they are the right person for the role
- Someone within the business must be nominated to manage the application process
    - This person (possibly together with others) will draw up a **shortlist** of candidates from the many applications received
    - The shortlist usually includes three to five candidates who are **invited to interview**

5. The selection process

- This process varies significantly between organisations
- Businesses must decide on the **most appropriate method** that will help them identify the best candidate
- The most commonly used methods include **interviews and assessment tasks**

Interviews and assessment tasks

Interviews	Assessment tasks
• Involves meeting (face-to-face or virtually, e.g. Zoom) and asking questions about the candidate's skills, experience and knowledge • It is important to prepare a **set of relevant**	• Provide shortlisted candidates with the opportunity to demonstrate their skills and suitability for the job • The assessment tasks may include **psychometric tests**,

conducted in a fair and consistent manner	

Costs of recruitment, selection and training

- Recruitment, training and selection are essential processes for any business to attract, develop and retain a skilled workforce
- These processes involve significant costs for businesses, which **can impact their overall profitability** and competitiveness

Costs of recruitment, selection and training

Recruitment costs	Training costs	Selection costs

the **expenses incurred in the process of hiring** new employees
• These include advertising, recruiting, interviewing and screening candidates
• **High labour turnover rates** can significantly increase these costs
  ○ When employees leave, the business has to spend money and time recruiting and training new employees to fill the vacant positions
	expenses incurred in the process of providing training to new or existing employees
	• These include the cost of trainers, training materials and facilities
	• The effectiveness of training can impact these costs
	  ○ If the training is not effective, employees **may require additional training** or take longer to learn new skills, which can **increase the cost of training**
		to the **expenses incurred in the process of selecting candidates** for employment
		• These include background checks and visa costs
		• **High labour turnover rates** can increase selection costs as the business has to spend more regularly

- By **reducing labour turnover rates** and **improving the effectiveness** of their training programmes, businesses can minimise these costs and improve their overall profitability and competitiveness

Types of training provided by businesses

- Different **types of training** have their advantages and disadvantages for the business

Training types

Three common types of training that businesses put their new employees through

Induction training

- Induction training is a type of training that **new employees receive** when they start working for a company
  - It introduces them to the company, its culture, policies and procedures, and their job roles and responsibilities
    - E.g. when a new employee joins Marks & Spencer, they receive induction training that covers customer service, product knowledge, store policies and safety procedures

Evaluation of induction training

Advantages	Disadvantages
• Helps new employees **understand their job roles** and responsibilities • Introduces employees to the company culture, policies and procedures • Improves employee confidence and motivation • **Reduces the time** taken for new employees to become **productive**	• Can be time-consuming and **expensive to organise** • May not cover all aspects of the job role • May not be effective in all cases, **leading to employee dissatisfaction** and higher turnover rates

On-the-job training

- A type of training that takes place **while employees are working** in their job roles
  - It allows employees to **learn new skills and knowledge** from colleagues while performing their job duties
    - E.g. A sous chef at The Ivy Restaurant in York may receive **on-the-job training from the chef** to learn how to prepare new dishes, **use new equipment** or improve their cooking techniques

Evaluation of on-the-job training

• Employees learn new skills and knowledge while performing their job duties • **Training is tailored** to the employee's specific job role and responsibilities • Training is often **more practical and relevant** to the employee's job duties • **Can be cost-effective** as it takes place during working hours	• Employees may make mistakes while learning, which can **impact productivity and quality** • Can be disruptive to the workplace as it **requires the trainer to devote time** to training the employee • May not be effective in all cases, leading to **employee dissatisfaction** and higher turnover rates

Off-the-job training

- A type of training that takes place **outside of the workplace**
  - It can be in the form of workshops, seminars, conferences or online courses
    - E.g. Teachers can attend exam board training days at which they learn how to better teach the syllabus and help their students prepare for their exams

Evaluation of off-the-job training

Advantages	Disadvantages
• Employees learn new skills and knowledge outside of the workplace, which can **bring fresh ideas and perspectives** to the workplace • **Training can be tailored** to the employee's specific needs and interests • Training can be **used as a reward** or incentive for high-performing employees • **Can be cost-effective** if training is provided online or through webinars	• Can be expensive to organise, especially if **travel and accommodation** are required • Employees may **miss work** while attending training, which can impact productivity • The training **may not be directly applicable** to the employee's job role or the needs of the firm

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